

Practice Paper 5

Power and humility; endings and new beginnings · Three hours · 100 marks

PAPER I · 40 MARKS

Answer **all** the questions in Section A. Select **either** I, II **or** III from Section B and answer all the questions given below it.

Paper I · Section A: Poetry, Prose and Drama 30 marks

Read the following extracts and answer all the questions given below them.

I POETRY

I (i) · PRACTICE QUESTION

"My mother thinks us long away;
'Tis time the field were mown.
She had two sons at rising day,
To-night she'll be alone."

(a) Name the poem from which these lines are taken. Name the poet. 1 mark

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(b) Who are 'us'? 1 mark

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(c) Why will the mother be alone tonight? 1 mark

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(d) What is the effect of the contrast in the last two lines? 2 marks

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I (ii) · PRACTICE QUESTION

"We climb out of bed with a frouzly head,
And a snarly-yarly voice.
We shiver and scowl and we grunt and we growl"

(a) Name the poem from which these lines are taken. Name the poet.

1 mark

(b) Who are 'We'?

1 mark

(c) Name one sound device in the third line.

1 mark

(d) What is the effect of the made-up words 'frouzly' and 'snarly-yarly'?

2 marks

II PROSE

II (i) • PRACTICE QUESTION

"You are not to go into the gooseberry garden," said the aunt, changing the subject.
"Why not?" demanded Nicholas.
"Because you are in disgrace," said the aunt loftily."

(a) Name the text from which these lines are taken. Name the author.

1 mark

(b) Why is Nicholas "in disgrace"?

1 mark

(c) Why does the aunt change the subject?

1 mark

(d) What does 'loftily' suggest about the aunt? Is her reasoning convincing?

2 marks

II (ii) • PRACTICE QUESTION

"We all sit in the dressing room and talk. Talk about what happened. Within minutes there is laughter and the jokes have started to flow."

(a) Name the text from which these lines are taken. Name the speaker/author. 1 mark

(b) Who are 'We'? 1 mark

(c) When does this happen? 1 mark

(d) Comment on the use of the present tense and the short sentences. 2 marks

III DRAMA

III (i) • PRACTICE QUESTION

"LUKA. It isn't right, madam.... You're just destroying yourself."

(a) Name the play from which these lines are taken. Name the playwright. 1 mark

(b) Who is Luka? 1 mark

(c) Why does he say she is 'destroying' herself? 1 mark

(d) What is the dramatic purpose of these opening words? 2 marks

III (ii) • PRACTICE QUESTION

"You're a boor! A coarse bear! A Bourbon! A monster!"

(a) Name the play from which these lines are taken. Name the playwright.

1 mark

(b) Who speaks these words, and to whom?

1 mark

(c) What has made the speaker so angry?

1 mark

(d) Why are these words important in the play?

2 marks

Paper I • Section B: Novels 10 marks

Select **EITHER** I, II **OR** III and answer all the questions given below it.

I • THE PRINCE AND THE PAUPER

Read the following extract from *The Prince and the Pauper* by Mark Twain and answer all the questions given below it.

"The King turned to Tom, and said kindly—"My poor boy, how was it that you could remember where I hid the Seal when I could not remember it myself?"

"Ah, my King, that was easy, since I used it divers days."

"Used it—yet could not explain where it was?"

"I did not know it was that they wanted. They did not describe it, your Majesty."

"Then how used you it?"

The red blood began to steal up into Tom's cheeks, and he dropped his eyes and was silent.

"Speak up, good lad, and fear nothing," said the King. "How used you the Great Seal of England?"

Tom stammered a moment, in a pathetic confusion, then got it out—

"To crack nuts with!"

(i) When and where does this incident take place?

2 marks

(ii) Why could Tom not tell the courtiers where the Great Seal was?

2 marks

(iii) Explain the meaning of the following phrase as it occurs in the passage: (a) used it divers days

1 mark

(b) in a pathetic confusion

1 mark

(iv) Why is this moment both humorous and important for the plot?

4 marks

II • BRINGING TONY HOME

After the family moves house, the narrator is sent back to the old neighbourhood with errands to do: buying rations, collecting the new ration books and fetching a dressing-table mirror. He adds:

"But I had another very important task to perform, something I had secretly vowed to myself I would do."

(i) When and where does this take place?

2 marks

(ii) What is the "very important task"?

2 marks

(iii) Explain the meaning of the following phrase as it occurs in the passage: (a) task to perform

1 mark

(b) secretly vowed

1 mark

(iv) What does this sentence reveal about the narrator? How does it build suspense?

4 marks

III • THE VENDOR OF SWEETS

Jagan hears that Mali wants to go to America to learn to write. His cousin brings the news to the shop. Jagan reacts:

"He should rather go to a village granny, he said, all his patriotic sentiment surging."

(i) When and where does this happen?

2 marks

(ii) Why is Jagan shocked?

2 marks

(iii) Explain the meaning of the following phrase as it occurs in the passage: (a) a village granny

1 mark

(b) patriotic sentiment surging

1 mark

(iv) What themes of the novel are reflected in this reaction?

4 marks

Paper II · Essays 60 marks

PAPER II · 60 MARKS

Answer **four** questions, selecting **one** each from the four sections: Poetry, Drama, Prose and Fiction.

HOW PAPER II ESSAYS ARE MARKED (15 MARKS EACH)

Content 7 · Organisation 4 · Language 4. Examiners reward relevant points from the text, apt quotations, a clear argument that answers the question, and your own sensible response. The points below are a guide, not a fixed list.

POETRY (Answer one question only)

1. How does Keats use personification and the sonnet form in 'To the Nile'?

15 marks

2. How does Szymborska use time to build tension in 'The Terrorist, He's Watching'?

15 marks

3. What is the role of the son in 'Once Upon a Time'?

15 marks

4. Discuss the symbols of the swallow, the princess and the queen in 'Fear'.

15 marks

5. "The title 'Two's Company' is the key to the poem's humour." Discuss.

15 marks

DRAMA (Answer one question only)

6. What message does 'Twilight of a Crane' carry for modern society?

15 marks

7. How do dialogue and stage directions create comedy in 'The Bear'?

15 marks

PROSE (Answer one question only)

8. "In 'Wave', the sea, a place of holiday pleasure, becomes a destructive force." Discuss. 15 marks

9. "At the end of 'The Lumber Room', Nicholas is the winner." Do you agree? 15 marks

10. How does Sangakkara show sympathy and humility in 'The Lahore Attack'? 15 marks

11. Discuss the character of the Student in 'The Nightingale and the Rose'. 15 marks

FICTION (Answer one question only)

12. "In 'The Prince and the Pauper', people are judged by their clothes." Discuss. 15 marks

13. How does 'Bringing Tony Home' recreate a vanished way of life in Sri Lanka? 15 marks

14. "Jagan's retreat at the end is an escape, not a spiritual awakening." Discuss. 15 marks

These are original LitHelp practice questions written to the format of the G.C.E. (O/L) 2023(2024) and 2024(2025) papers and the Ministry of Education's 2025(2026) model papers. They are not official past-paper questions. For copyrighted set texts, only short lines are quoted and the situation is described in our own words.